🌿 Budget Kerala Escape: Thekkady, Vagamon & Ernakulam

Duration: 5 Days / 4 Nights
Departure: Bengaluru (BLR)
Travelers: 2 Adults
Style: Budget / Coffee Routes
Dates: October 16 – October 20, 2026

---

1. Trip Summary

This itinerary is designed to maximize your experience while keeping costs low. We leverage **Kochi (COK)** as your flight hub, as it offers more frequent and cheaper connections from Bengaluru compared to Madurai. The route flows logically from the wilds of **Thekkady**, up to the tea hills of **Vagamon**, and concludes with a cultural stop in **Ernakulam (Kochi)** before your return flight.

- **Route:** Bengaluru → Kochi → Thekkady → Vagamon → Kochi → Bengaluru
- **Focus:** Wildlife, Tea Gardens, Backwaters, and Local Cuisine.
- **Transport:** Private Sedan Cab (Recommended for door-to-door convenience and cost-sharing between 2 travelers).

---

2. Flight Information

Note: Live flight pricing for October 2026 is not yet available via standard APIs. The estimates below are based on historical average fares for budget carriers (IndiGo, Akasa Air, Air India Express).

Leg 1: Bengaluru (BLR) → Kochi (COK)

- **Date:** Oct 16, 2026
- **Suggested Timing:** Early Morning (06:30 AM – 08:30 AM) to maximize Day 1.
- **Estimated Cost:** ₹2,500 – ₹3,500 per person (One-way).
- **Tip:** Book 2–3 months in advance for the best deal.

Leg 2: Kochi (COK) → Bengaluru (BLR)

- **Date:** Oct 20, 2026
- **Suggested Timing:** Late Afternoon/Evening (04:00 PM – 07:00 PM).
- **Estimated Cost:** ₹2,500 – ₹3,500 per person (One-way).

Alternative Airport Note: While Madurai (IXM) was requested as an option, Kochi is significantly closer to Thekkady and Vagamon. Flying into Madurai would add ~1.5–2 hours of extra travel time and cost to reach the first destination. Stick with **Kochi (COK)** for this specific route.
